

## WEEK 2 LESSON GUIDE

**STICK  
TOGETHER**

### BIG IDEA

Wise friends will help guide you.

### BIBLE

Proverbs 13:20; I Kings 3:3–14;  
Psalm 1:1–3

### ABOUT THIS WEEK

Following a trusted ally or being misled by a reckless person can be the difference between finding treasure or getting trapped. This week, we'll see how King Solomon's choice to ask God for wisdom set him up to lead well, especially as he would face many differing voices. Surrounding ourselves with those who point us to what's right reminds us that **wise friends will help guide us.**

### WHAT? What are we talking about?



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School Hacks



#### ACTIVITY | Mad Libs Theater: Bad Advice Edition

- Welcome back to *Stick Together*, a series where we're talking about friendship and adventure, too, because those things tend to go together, don't they?
- There are a lot of adventure movies where friends have to "stick together" to survive a dangerous situation or complete an epic quest. But if you've seen *Indiana Jones*, *Jumanji*, *Jurassic Park*, and other movies in that genre, you might start to notice they have a lot of things in common. You might start to think you could write your own.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Ask 4–5 students to act in an improvised scripted scene about three friends trying to make progress on an epic quest. You'll need [index cards](#) or [poster board](#), [permanent markers](#), and jungle-themed props like [fake tropical plants](#), [jungle-themed props](#), and [safari hats](#). Use the [Mad Lib Theater script and instructions](#) we've provided in your Week 2 folder to crowdsource a script your actors will perform.



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#### QUESTION | Tell us about a time you got really bad advice.

- You've probably never needed advice on how to avoid getting eaten by an actual monster, but we've all been in situations where we needed guidance but got bad advice instead. Maybe your friend told you to do something that got you in tons of trouble, or maybe your dad just gave you awful fashion tips. Whatever it was, **tell us about a time you got really bad advice.**
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Give a few students a chance to respond.

#### DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.
  - **Quick! Give us a really terrible piece of advice.**



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- When do you usually ask your friends for advice? When do you not ask them for advice? Why do you think that is?

### VIDEO | A Clip From *Jurassic Park*

- Obviously, getting good, trusted, wise advice is not always easy. Most people (like dads with bad fashion sense) are wise in a lot of areas... but can still get things wrong. And then other people just don't seem very wise at all!
- Like in *Jurassic Park* (the original!), there's this guy named Dennis. This man couldn't have possibly been more unwise. He made a series of decisions so dumb that it's given us seven movies' worth (so far) of drama. And dinosaurs.
  - Jurassic Park, of course, is the fictional amusement park where you can go see dinosaurs in real life.
  - Dennis is a computer programmer who works for Jurassic Park, and he's not a great guy. He decides to sabotage the park security system, steal some of the dinosaur embryos, and sell them for a ton of money.
  - That was his first unwise decision, but plenty more follow, like...
    - Turning off every single security fence that kept the dinosaurs from escaping.
    - Getting lost in the dinosaur-infested jungle because he wasn't prepared.
    - And not bothering to learn anything about those dinosaurs at all, including how to survive them.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** As a teaching tool, play [two short clips](#) (0:20–1:12 and 2:00–2:50) from *Jurassic Park* where Dennis is stalked by a dinosaur. We always suggest viewing the clip beforehand to ensure it's a good fit for your context! [Read this](#) for more information on legally using copyrighted material for educational purposes!
- You'll have to watch the movie to see Dennis' fate, but let's just say it didn't end well for him. Sometimes, unwise decisions—spoiler alert—can get you eaten by a dilophosaurus.

## SO WHAT? Why does it matter to God and to us?



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### STORY | Talk about a wise friend.

- Some unwise people are easy to spot, but most people aren't as clear-cut as a movie villain or hero. Most people are somewhere in the middle, which means they can surprise you sometimes with their wisdom, or lack of it.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Tell a story from your own life (or ask a volunteer or student to tell a story) about a time you were surprised by the wisdom of a friend. First, help students get to know them by sharing what they were like and why you were friends. Then talk about how they gave you unexpected or timely advice, or you watched them make a mature or wise decision that gave you new appreciation for their wisdom. Share how they or their wisdom impacted you as a friend.
- When you hear the word "wise," who do you think about? Maybe it's your grandmother, a mentor you look up to, someone smart you like to learn from, or some 800-year-old bearded wizard guy from your favorite movie.



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- Looking up to people who are older and wiser than us is always a good idea. But wisdom isn't something that's only available to you when you start to get wrinkles. In fact, you've probably got at least one friend who has some wisdom to share with you right now. And you've probably got some wisdom to share with your friends, too!

### QUESTION | When was one of your friends wise?

- We already shared some stories of *un-wisdom*, but now let's highlight the wisdom of our friends for a second. **When was one of your friends wise?**
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Give a few students a chance to respond.

### DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.
  - \* **Who are some of your wisest friends? In what ways, or with what topics, do you think they're wise?**
  - \* **How do you think those people got so wise? What do they have in common?**
  - \* **Do you think most people tend to overestimate or underestimate how wise they are? Why do you think so? (And what do you think you do?)**



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### SCRIPTURE | Proverbs 13:20

- Last week, we talked about a book of the Bible called Proverbs, that's all about wisdom. It's written by a guy named Solomon, and it's packed with wise advice about just about everything, including friendships. Here's a pretty well-known proverb you may have heard before...
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Read Proverbs 13:20.
- This makes sense, right? If the people you're closest to are wise, you're going to start becoming more wise over time too. That's because wise friends are more likely to...
  - Give good advice.
  - Make good decisions.
  - Help you learn new things or see things differently.
  - Be a good influence on your whole friend group.
- This might seem like a straightforward piece of advice: hang out with wise people and you'll get more wise. But maybe it brings up a few more questions, like...
  - Is hanging out with wise people going to be boring?
  - Can I only hang out with wise people? Or is it still okay to hang out with people who are, um, *not exactly* wise?
  - How do we find friends who are wise?
  - How do we get wise people to want to be our friends?
  - What do we do if our current friends don't seem very wise?
  - Is "wise" something you naturally are or aren't, like being tall or having brown eyes? Or can you become more or less wise?
  - How do we become the kind of person our friends would call wise?

**SCRIPTURE | 1 Kings 3:3–14**

- We can talk about all of these questions together, but before we get there, let's take a closer look at the guy who wrote the book of Proverbs, King Solomon. But Solomon wasn't always wise... so how did he become the guy who wrote this whole book of wise sayings?
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Read 1 Kings 3:3–14.
- We don't know exactly how old Solomon was when this took place, but most Bible scholars think he was somewhere between twelve and fifteen. That means he became king when he was around your age! So it makes sense that he'd be asking God for wisdom, right? Ruling a whole country is a big responsibility!
- Here are some things you might find interesting about Solomon...
  - **He loved God.** He showed it not just through his words, but through his actions. That's the foundation of wisdom—not just knowing or talking about what's good and right, but actually doing it.
  - **He looked for examples.** Solomon wasn't making decisions on his own. He was actively looking for wise guidance from his father who ruled before him and tried to follow the best of his example.
  - **He was humble.** Solomon knew he was young, untested, and lacking wisdom. Even though he was king, he didn't think more highly of himself than he deserved. He was honest about how much more he still had to learn. That's what humility is. It's seeing both your strengths and weaknesses clearly, and knowing you still have room to grow.
  - **He asked for help.** Solomon could have asked for anything from God, but he asked for the best thing he could have asked for: help. He wanted wisdom and knew he couldn't get it on his own. For that, he needed God's help. And God gave it to him!
- Maybe wisdom seems mysterious or hard to achieve. Maybe you look at people you consider wise and feel like they're a totally different species—something you could never be. But the truth is, wisdom is pretty simple and easy to get... if you're willing to do the work.
- So what about your friends? Are they wise and helping you become more wise, like Solomon said?
  - Do they love God and help you love God more?
  - Are they trying to follow the example of wise people, or do they just trust their own instincts?
  - Are they humble or are they arrogant?
  - Do they ask for help from God and others or do they think they've got it all figured out?
- And what about you?
  - Is your love for God showing up in your actions and not just your words?
  - Are you trying to follow the example of people who are wiser or more experienced than you?
  - Are you humble enough to know you still have more to learn?
  - Are you asking God to give you more wisdom?
- Solomon asked for wisdom as a kid. So don't think about wisdom as something you'll get when you get older. Pursue God's wisdom right now, and pursue it

together! Your friends need wise friends, and so do you. Because **wise friends will help guide you.**

### NOW WHAT? What does God want us to do about it?

#### DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** *If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.*
  - **Why do you think people aren't more willing to admit they need guidance or don't know what to do?**
  - **\* In what ways do you relate to young King Solomon? In what ways could you learn from his example?**



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#### QUESTION | When might you need wisdom?

- Wisdom is one of those things you don't often think about until you need it. Unfortunately, if you haven't already planned ahead and collected a bunch of wisdom, you won't have it when you really need it.
- So what do you think? What are some situations you've already faced (or might face in the future) when you could really use guidance or help? **When might you need wisdom?**
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** *Give a few students a chance to respond.*



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Spend Time  
With God

#### REFLECTION | Surrounded by Wisdom

- With all of these challenges and difficult scenarios, life can feel a little bit like trying to navigate a dark jungle, can't it? It might seem like there's danger around every corner. Peer pressure! Big decisions! Scary monsters! Flooded roads! Dinosaurs!
- But if life ever starts to feel that way, remember you're surrounded by more than just danger. You're surrounded by wisdom too.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** *For this activity, you'll need [monstera-leaf-shaped note cards](#) or [faux monstera leaves](#), tape, and [permanent markers](#). Brainstorm together as many sources of wisdom as you can. Guide students to list the most important sources, like Scripture, the Holy Spirit, and Jesus' example, as well as people (like parents, teachers, mentors, and adult leaders) and helpful tools (like books, the internet, or even asking an AI app to summarize godly advice). For each source of wisdom mentioned, write it on a leaf and tape it to a wall, board, or your series backdrop to create a "jungle" of wisdom.*



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Spend Time  
With Others

#### ACTIVITY | Wisdom Quest

- We're looking at all sorts of adventure stories in this series because friendships and adventure tend to go together. Good friendships usually make life more adventurous, and most adventures are a lot easier when you have trusted friends by your side.
- For this quest I'm about to give you, you won't be searching for the lost Ark or dinosaur embryos inside a can of Barbasol. You'll be searching for wisdom—and yes, you'll have some friends by your side.

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Split students into groups of 3–5. Refer back to the types of situations you already brainstormed where they might need wisdom. If needed, help them brainstorm more situations, like deciding what to do when their friend group is fighting, or experiencing peer pressure, or choosing what to do after graduation. Next, have students vote on a topic they want to research. You can either research one topic as a group or have each group choose their own topic. When the topics are decided, give students five minutes to rapidly research wise advice on that topic. Encourage them to prioritize wisdom from Scripture by searching on their phones or in a physical Bible, but invite them to try any of the methods or people they just brainstormed too. At the end of five minutes, have each group share some of the most helpful wisdom they found.
- See how this can work? Wisdom is never that far away, but we need to ask and look for it, just like Solomon did. And in many ways, you already know how to do it!
- If you had a set of directions that led you and your friends toward wisdom, it might sound like this:
  - **LOVE GOD.** God is the Creator and source of all wisdom, so getting closer to God will always get you closer to wisdom.
  - **LEARN FROM WISE EXAMPLES.** From Jesus, to Solomon, to people we look up to, and to the wise people we know in real life, we can learn a lot from how wise people live their lives, make decisions, and follow God.
  - **HUMBLE YOURSELF.** You don't know everything and you get a lot of things wrong. That's not an insult—it's true of me, too! We're all imperfect and unwise at times. So when we're feeling like we know it all, we need to remind ourselves we don't.
  - **ASK FOR HELP.** Ask God for wisdom. Ask others for advice. Ask for help using any of those ideas we brainstormed today. Asking for help isn't a sign of weakness—it's a sign of wisdom.
  - **DO SOMETHING, TOGETHER.** This might be the most important step on your quest for wisdom. The difference between knowledge and true wisdom is what you do with the knowledge you gained. So if you and your friends really do want to grow in wisdom, then do something about it. Put what you learn into practice.
- When life gets challenging or confusing...
  - You need wise friends to help guide you.
  - And your friends need the wisest version of you to help guide them, too.
- So keep searching for wisdom together. And when you've got a friend who's growing in wisdom, make sure you stick together. Because **wise friends will help guide you.**

## DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.
  - **Read Psalm 1:1–3. Do you think this verse means God wants us to only be friends with other Christians? If not, what do you think it means?**

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- What's one specific area of your life where you need wisdom right now? What do you think you could do to get it?
  - This week, what's one way you want to grow in wisdom? What's one way you and your friends can grow in wisdom together?